

DRISHTI GOEL

Ph.D. Candidate UIUC | Prev. Research Fellow, Microsoft Research

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🌐 <https://drishti-illini.github.io>

🎓 Google Scholar

🌐 LinkedIn

EDUCATION

University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign

2025 – Present

Ph.D. (Direct Entry) in Computer Science, Advisor: **Prof. Koustuv Saha**

→ Funded by the Qualcomm Innovation Fellowship

Dayalbagh Educational Institute, Agra

2019 – 2023

B.Tech in Electrical Engineering (Specialization in Computer Science)

CGPA: 9.573/10.00

→ University Founder's Medal (1 out of ≈ 5000) & Director's Medals Recipient (1 out of ≈ 500)

EXPERIENCE

1. Microsoft Research

May, 2026 - Present

Incoming Research Intern | Advisors: Dr. Martez Mott, Dr. Denae Ford Robinson

Redmond, USA

2. Microsoft-365 Research

August, 2023 - August, 2025

Research Fellow | Advisors: Dr. Supriyo Ghosh, Chetan Bansal

Bangalore, India

→ Worked on AI for IT and Cloud Systems (AIOPs), LLMs & SLMs for service reliability in large-scale cloud systems and developer productivity & satisfaction

→ In addition to the research impact, the work has also been adopted by over 130 teams across Microsoft

3. Grahn Lab, University of Western Ontario

June - August, 2022

MITACS GRI Research Intern | Advisors: Prof. Jessica Grahn, Dr. Swathi Swaminathan

London, Canada

→ Using Pupillometry to detect emotions induced by music in Alzheimer's Patients

→ Skills Acquired: Conducting systematic reviews, developing search strategies and working on various databases and database managers, Pupillometry, and conducting testing sessions.

4. NeenOpal Inc.

Jan - May, 2022

Data Science Intern | Advisor: Raghav Kedia

Bangalore, India

→ Business intelligence and ML-driven decision-making using Power BI, Tableau, and Google Analytics

→ Articles: Power BI Screenshot Automation, Visualizing the World Using Power BI

5. Geniusup India Pvt. Ltd.

June - August, 2021

Topic Modeling using Latent Dirichlet Allocation (LDA)

Agra, India (Online)

→ Skills Acquired: Web Scraping, Data Cleansing, and Visualization (using Python), Machine Learning (unsupervised), Latent Dirichlet Allocation (LDA) Algorithm, High-level document drafting

PUBLICATIONS

S = UNDER SUBMISSION, C = CONFERENCE (= EQUAL CONTRIBUTION)*

[C.5] Rubric-Driven Risk Mitigation in Caregiver-AI Interactions Optimization 🔗

Drishti Goel, Jeongah Lee, Qiuyue Zhong, Violeta J. Rodriguez, Daniel S. Brown, Ravi Karkar, Dong Whi Yoo, Koustuv Saha

ACM Association for Computational Linguistics

[ACL'26]

[C.4] Do We Know What They Know We Know? Calibrating Student Trust in AI and Human Responses Through Mutual Theory of Mind 🔗

Olivia Pal, Veda Duddu, Agam Goyal, Drishti Goel, Koustuv Saha

ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems

[CHI'26]

[S.1] Efficient Automated Root Cause Analysis with Prompt Optimization 🔗

Drishti Goel, Raghav Magazine, Supriyo Ghosh, Akshay Nambi, Prathamesh Deshpande, Xuchao Zhang, Chetan Bansal, Saravan Rajmohan

[C.3] Time Warp: The Gap Between Developers' Ideal vs Actual Workweeks in an AI Driven Era 🔗

Sukrit Kumar*, Drishti Goel*, Thomas Zimmermann, Brian Houck, B. Ashok, Chetan Bansal

🏆 Distinguished Paper Award International Conference On Software Engineering

[ICSE-SEIP'25]

[C.2] Prototype-Reservation for Explainable Classification under Imbalanced & Scarce-Data Settings 🔗

Vaibhav Ganatra, Drishti Goel

Machine Learning in Healthcare (University of Toronto)

[MLHC'24]

[C.1] X-lifecycle Learning for Cloud Incident Management using LLMs 🔗

Drishti Goel, Fiza Husain, Aditya Singh, Supriyo Ghosh, Anjaly Parayil, Chetan Bansal, Xuchao Zhang, Saravan Rajmohan

ACM International Conference on the Foundations of Software Engineering

[FSE'24]

SELECT PROJECTS

1. **MediTrain AI - Empowering the doctors of tomorrow, today** 2023
 - Presented a novel AI-driven application designed to revolutionize medical training by generating a diverse range of patient personas. This innovation empowers trainee doctors to practice an array of diagnostic procedures in a risk-free, controlled environment.
 - Grand winner of the Microsoft Fix-Hack-Learn Hackathon
2. **Quantum Game Theory** 2023
 - Developed an optimal strategy for single & double player Quantum Games such as Quantum Tic-Tac-Toe & Tant-Fant
3. **ML Interventions for Weed Detection using Multispectral Imagery and Unmanned Aerial Vehicles** 2023
 - Systematic review on the opportunities and efforts around utilizing ML and UAVs for weed detection 
4. **Image Caption Generator - Eyes for the Blind** 2022
 - Worked on building a neural image caption generator using CNN encoders and RNN decoders. Next, using Google's Text-To-Speech library (gTTS) we converted the generated captions to speech
5. **Innovative PPE design for Healthcare Workers** 2022
 - Developed and presented the product prototype at the National Level AICTE Chattra Vishwakarma Awards Exhibition in front of the Honorable Minister of Education, Shri Dharmendra Pradhan
 - The project was published in the annual AICTE Chattra Vishwakarma Award 2020 Booklet
6. **Smart Home Automation to Aid the Caregiving of Dementia and Alzheimer's Patients** 2022
 - Built a working model to aid the caregiving of Dementia and Alzheimer's patients, many of whom had been living alone during the lockdown. This was done by implementing home automation and alert systems (via calls, messages, and alarms) using the Internet of Things

AWARDS & ACHIEVEMENTS

1. Funded by the **Qualcomm Innovation Fellowship** at UIUC 2025
2. Recieved the **Distinguished Paper Award** at the International Conference On Software Engineering 2025
3. **University Founder's Medal** Recipient (1 out of ≈ 5000 graduates) 2024
 - Awarded annually to a student for academic excellence, social service, and an all-rounder personality
4. **Director's Medal**– Two times recipient (1 out of ≈ 500 graduates) 2024
 - Awarded for scoring the highest Grade-Point Average across all engineering streams, and
 - For scoring the highest grades in Cultural Education across the University
5. **MITACS Globalink Research Scholarship** Recipient ($\approx$ CAD 8,000) | University of Western Ontario 2022
 - Eligible to receive the MITACS Globalink Graduate Fellowship ($\approx$ CAD 15,000)
6. Amongst the 15 students, selected for a student exchange program with the **Hong Kong University** out of $\approx 3,000$ university applicants 2020
7. Received the runners-up position at the Zonal-level Debate Competition at the AIU Youth Festival 2019
 - Represented Region at the **National Level**

TALKS & PRESENTATIONS

1. Guest Speaker @Google Developer Student Club on “The Fundamentals & Applications of ML” 2022
2. University representative and speaker at the Engineer's Day conference alongside **Mr. Sam Pitroda** 2021
 - The internationally renowned telecoms innovator and policymaker.
3. Project– “Entrepreneurial Methodology to Increase the Income of Rural Areas in India” 2020
 - Qualified & presented at the **AICTE CVA National Level** to the Education Minister of India
4. Presented my project, “Preservation and Integration of the Heritage of India and Hong Kong” 2020
 - In collaboration with **The Hong Kong University**
5. Selected– “*Frugal Innovation with Foldscope*” workshop, by Dr. Manu Prakash from **Stanford University** 2019

LEADERSHIP POSITIONS

- **Author**– “Defy Your Gravity: Rise Above Challenges & Embrace Your Potential”  2025
- **Active Volunteer**– Fostering Cultural Diversity among Young Minds through Arts  2023-Present
- **‘MAA’**– A social initiative to help Indian village women achieve financial independence 2021
 - Work presented at the National Level of the AICTE Chattra Vishwakarma Award Competition
- University Chair, IEEE Women in Engineering 2020 – 2023
- *Member*: IEEE Computer Society, IEL, System Society Of India, University's Incubation Cell 2019 – 2023